

CAR RENTAL REQUEST AUTOMATION IN SERVICENOW

Phase 4: Project Planning Phase

Sets out the order of work, the milestones, the roles, and how the results are protected, tested, and tracked.

Item	Details
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Program	SkillWallet, ServiceNow Global Certification
Platform	ServiceNow (Service Catalog, Flow Designer, Business Rules)
Document	Phase 4 of 5

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4.1 Planning Approach

The work is planned in milestones that follow the natural build order of a ServiceNow solution: data first (catalog item and variables), then automation (flow), then exception handling (business rule), then verification and deployment. Each milestone has a clear output that the next one depends on, so the plan can be checked at every step.

4.2 Roadmap and Milestones

Milestone	Scope	Depends on	Built in
M1	Catalog Item creation	None	Section 5.3
M2	Form setup: variables and choices	M1	Section 5.3
M3	Workflow design in Flow Designer	M2 (variables are used as data pills)	Section 5.4
M4	Task automation (Catalog Task)	M3	Section 5.4
M5	Notifications (Send Email)	M4	Section 5.4
M6	Business Rules	M1 and M2 (needs the RITM and the requested date)	Section 5.5

Milestone	Scope	Depends on	Built in
M7	Testing	M3 to M6	Section 5.8
M8	Deployment through Update Set	M7	Section 5.9

4.3 Work Breakdown Structure

On SkillWallet the project is organized into six epics: five phases and a project conclusion, with 26 tasks and 6 subtasks in total.

Epic	Stories	Duration
Phase 1: Requirement Analysis & Planning	Business Objectives, Functional Scope, Stakeholder Mapping, Execution Roadmap	59m
Phase 2: Backend Development & Configuration Data Architecture	Data Architecture, Business Rules, Automation Logic	3h 0m
Phase 3: UI/UX Development & Customization	Interface Design, Navigation Flow, Usability, Tooltips & Help Text	1h 39m
Phase 4: Data Migration, Testing & Security	Automation Logic, Attach Workflow to Catalog Item, Finalize and Move Update Set	Per SkillWallet
Phase 5: Deployment, Documentation & Final Presentation	Deployment, documentation, presentation	Per SkillWallet
Project Conclusion	Wrap-up and review	Per SkillWallet

Story-level estimates recorded on SkillWallet

Story	Epic	Estimate
Business Objectives	Phase 1	19m
Functional Scope	Phase 1	20m
Stakeholder Mapping	Phase 1	10m
Execution Roadmap	Phase 1	10m
Data Architecture	Phase 2	1h
Automation Logic	Phase 2	1h
Interface Design	Phase 3	59m
Navigation Flow	Phase 3	20m
Attach Workflow to Catalog Item	Phase 4	20m

4.4 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Held by	Responsibilities
Designer, developer, tester, and documenter	Suresh Katta (individual project)	All phases, from requirements to deployment
Approver (for testing)	The user named in the approval rule	Approve the test request
Transport Team	The Transport Team group	Receives and closes the catalog task
Mentor	Not yet assigned on SkillWallet	Reviews the demo link and repository once added

4.5 Tools and Environment Plan

Tool / environment	Use
ServiceNow developer instance	Build and test the catalog item, flow, and business rule
Service Catalog (Maintain Items)	Create the catalog item and variables
Flow Designer (Workflow Studio)	Build, test, and activate the flow
System Definition, Business Rules	Create the incident business rule
Update Sets	Capture and move the configuration
SkillWallet	Track phases and submit the demo link and repository

4.6 Configuration Management: Update Set Strategy

An **Update Set** records every change made in the instance, such as the catalog item, its variables, the flow, and the business rule, as a set of update records that can be exported and committed on another instance. Because ServiceNow adds each change to whichever Update Set is **current** at that moment, the current set must be chosen deliberately before any work begins.

- Create a dedicated, named Update Set for this project and make it current before building.
- Check the Update Set banner at the top of the screen before each edit.
- At the end, mark the Update Set complete and move it to the target instance.
- Avoid relying on the "Default" set for anything that must be transported.

4.7 Testing Strategy

Level	What is tested	How
Component	Each flow action does what it should	Flow Designer Test button; check each action's status
End to end	Order, approval, task, and email work together	Order from the catalog, approve, and verify the results

Level	What is tested	How
Record checks	REQ, RITM, task, and incident states are correct	Open each record and compare with the expected result
Negative paths	Rejection and unavailable-car behaviour	Reject a request; set the state that the business rule checks

4.8 Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Flow does not trigger	Medium	High	Confirm the trigger is Service Catalog and the flow is Active and Published
Approver unavailable	Medium	Medium	Use an approval group or manager-based rule in future
Wrong assignment group	Low	Medium	Verify the Transport Team group exists and has members
Changes not captured in the intended Update Set	Medium	High	Create a named set and check the current set before every edit
Email not sent	Medium	Medium	Check that the Requestor resolves to an email address, and check the email log
Business Rule fires unexpectedly	Medium	Medium	Make the rule's condition explicit and test it with known states

4.9 Quality Gates and Exit Criteria

Phase	Exit criteria
1. Ideation	Problem, objectives, stakeholders, and chosen approach agreed
2. Requirements	Every requirement has an ID, acceptance criteria, and a place in the build
3. Design	Form, flow, data, and business rule are specified
4. Planning	Milestones, roles, risks, and testing approach agreed
5. Development	Catalog item, flow, and business rule built and tested; Update Set finalized

4.10 Progress Tracking and Open Items

Deliverable	Status
Catalog item with seven variables	Done
Flow "Car Rental Req" (Active, Published)	Done
Business Rule "Create Incident If Car Unavailable"	Done

Deliverable	Status
Update Set	Finalize and move (Section 5.9)
Demo link	To be added on SkillWallet
GitHub repository link	To be added on SkillWallet
Mentor assignment	Pending on SkillWallet

SkillWallet currently shows the project at 90 percent progress. The open items above account for the remainder.